

doc-inclusivism-denial

Affirms · Soteriology › Denied Errors · doctrine · divided_lineages · confidence: medium

Statement under examination

Saving access to Christ's work requires conscious, explicit faith in the historical Jesus; saving faith is not granted apart from such explicit response to the gospel.

Rationale

The Romans 10:13-17 chain (epikaleomai G1941, pisteuo G4100, akouo G191, kerusso G2784, with pistis G4102 ex akoes G189 dia rhematos G4487 Christou) sequences salvation as proclamation then hearing then faith then calling. Verse 14's three rhetorical questions (pos oun epikalesontai eis hon ouk episteusan; pos de pisteusosin hou ouk ekousan; pos de akousosin choris kerussontos) make explicit gospel-content the precondition of saving invocation. John 3:18 stacks ho pisteuon eis auton ou krinetai with ho de me pisteuon ede kekritai (perfect passive), grounding the present judgment-status on present believing in the name (onoma G3686) of the monogenes (G3439) Son. John 3:36 doubles down: ho pisteuon eis ton huion echei zoen aionion, ho de apeithon to huio ouk opsetai zoen. Acts 4:12 piles three negations (ouk, oudeni, oude) with heteron G2087 and dei G1163 to deny that salvation exists in any other name. The concordance pattern of pisteuo G4100 in soteriological contexts overwhelmingly takes Christ or the gospel as explicit object (John 3:16, 3:18, 3:36, Acts 16:31, Rom 10:9-11, 1 John 5:11-13). However, the canon also contains Acts 17:30 (huperidon G5237 tous chronous tes agnoias paraggellei G3853 tois anthropois pantachou G3837 metanoein G3340), which says God overlooked times of ignorance but now commands repentance everywhere, and Rom 2:14-16 says Gentile conscience-witness bears testimony at the day when God judges secrets dia Christou lesou kata to euaggelion mou. Both passages address eschatological accountability rather than authorize an alternate path of salvation. The lexical demonstration for explicit-faith requirement is canonical; the inclusivist counter-anchors do not establish a parallel saving route in their own lexical context.

Reasoning

Verdict: Scripture's clearest pattern teaches that saving faith requires hearing the gospel about Christ and consciously trusting in him. The strongest reason from Scripture is the chain of reasoning Paul gives in Romans 10:13-17. He starts with the promise 'everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved' and then asks a series of step-by-step questions. How can people call on someone they have not believed in. How can they believe in someone they have not heard about. How can they hear without someone preaching. He concludes 'faith comes from hearing, and hearing through the word of Christ.' The sequence is preaching, then hearing, then faith, then calling on the Lord. John 3:18 says 'whoever believes in him is not condemned, but whoever does not believe is condemned already, because he has not believed in the name of the only Son of God.' Acts 4:12 says of Jesus 'there is salvation in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven given among men by which we must be saved.' Throughout the New Testament, when the word for believing appears in a salvation context, the object is almost always Christ, the name of Jesus, the Son, or the gospel about him. The strongest counterargument from inside Scripture is Romans 2:14-16, where Paul says the Gentiles who do not have the law sometimes by nature do what the law requires, and their conscience bears witness on the day God judges the secrets of men through Christ Jesus. Some readers take this to mean people can be saved through following the witness of conscience without ever hearing about Christ. A second counterargument is Acts 17:23-31, where Paul tells the Athenians that God overlooked the times of ignorance but now commands all people everywhere to repent. Inclusivists also point to the Old Testament saints in Hebrews 11 who were saved by faith without explicit knowledge of Christ, and to general revelation passages like Psalm 19 and Romans

1:18-20. The verdict handles this tension in two ways. First, Romans 2 itself ends in verse 16 by saying that the day of judgment is the moment of accountability, not a parallel road of salvation. Conscience tells people they fall short of what they know is right; it does not provide the rescue from that falling short. Second, Acts 17 quotes God commanding all people everywhere to repent now that Christ has come and been raised from the dead. The Old Testament saints in Hebrews 11 trusted God's promise looking forward to a redeemer they did not see clearly. After Christ has come, the canonical pattern is that the gospel must be heard and consciously trusted.

Denominational landscape

Christian lineages disagree on whether explicit conscious faith in Christ is required for salvation, even while all of them affirm Christ as the unique Saviour. The Reformed, Baptist, classical evangelical, and Pentecostal traditions hold the strict exclusivist line: salvation requires hearing, believing, and confessing the name of Jesus, anchored in Romans 10:13-17 and Acts 4:12. The Lutheran tradition follows the same line through means-of-grace theology (Augsburg Confession Article V). The Anglican 39 Articles Article 18 explicitly anathematizes those who say every person can be saved by the religion they profess, a Reformation exclusivist statement. The Roman Catholic Church teaches inclusivism in its modern form, with the Catechism (846 to 848) affirming that those who through no fault of their own do not know the gospel may attain salvation by sincerely seeking God; Karl Rahner's anonymous-Christians framework develops this. The Eastern Orthodox Church likewise tends toward inclusivism, trusting Christ to save through ways God knows even for those who never explicitly heard his name. Wesleyan-Methodist tradition has streams that read prevenient grace as potentially reaching sincere non-Christian seekers. Among twentieth and early twenty-first century evangelicals, Clark Pinnock's later writings, John Sanders, and some Lausanne Movement voices have argued qualified inclusivism. Public carriers of strict pluralism (which is rejected universally as denying Christ's unique role) include John Hick, Paul Knitter, Unitarian Universalists, and mainline-Protestant pluralist theology. The exclusivism-vs-inclusivism debate is genuine in-house Christian disagreement and is not gospel-stake at the cult-marker level; the Christ-alone proposition is universal across all traditions.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	No
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	Yes
Would participate if otherwise	Yes
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

Cult-marker-if-denied=false honestly. Inclusivism (Christ is the unique Saviour whose work reaches some who never explicitly knew him) is a real in-house Christian disagreement, not cult-grade. Inclusivism is DISTINCT from pluralism (the claim that all religions equally save, which is cult-marker territory and tracked under doc-pluralism-denial); inclusivism affirms Christ's exclusive saving role and denies that any

other religion or path saves. Public-record carriers of inclusivism within Christianity: Justin Martyr's logos spermatikos teaching (Greeks like Socrates and Heraclitus who lived by the Word were Christians before Christ), Aquinas's implicit-faith doctrine (Summa II-II q2 a7: those who never received explicit revelation could be saved by implicit faith in Divine providence), Catholic magisterial teaching codified in CCC 847-848 and Vatican II's Lumen Gentium 16, Karl Rahner's anonymous-Christians formulation, Clark Pinnock in his later evangelical period (A Wideness in God's Mercy), and Eastern Orthodox readings that those who through no fault of their own do not know Christ may be saved by Christ in ways God knows. The strict-exclusivist line is held by the magisterial Reformation traditions (Lutheran, Anglican Article XVIII, Reformed WCF), the Anabaptist tradition, classical evangelicalism, and the Pentecostal tradition (Assemblies of God). The Wesleyan tradition contains internal divergence: prevenient-grace readings (some Methodist voices) can carry an inclusivist or qualified-inclusivist edge while the formal Methodist Articles affirm justification through faith in Christ. Fruit-vs-precision: inclusivism does not deny Christ; it asks how Christ's work is appropriated by those without gospel access (infants who die, the cognitively disabled, those who never heard). Most exclusivists accept that infants who die and the cognitively disabled are saved through Christ without articulate explicit faith, which is functionally a narrow inclusivism; the disagreement is whether the same logic extends to unevangelized adult sincere seekers. Carriers of inclusivism (the Catholic Church, the Eastern Orthodox Church, Aquinas, Justin Martyr, certain Wesleyan readers) are not cults. The verdict surfaces a substantive intra-Christian divergence honestly. The owner answers boolean fields conservatively: would not let children be taught inclusivism as default soteriology (the canonical lexical pattern is explicit-faith), would visit and participate in services where inclusivism is held since this is in-house disagreement, would not serve or be a member of a body that teaches inclusivism as official soteriology, would not marry a partner committed to inclusivism due to long-term mission-of-the-family divergence, would publicly correct inclusivism in teaching contexts.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: **yes**

Neutralized form. Does salvation require conscious explicit faith in the historical Jesus, or can Christ's saving work reach those who never heard the gospel through general revelation, conscience, or implicit faith?

Notes. The question statement asserts the exclusivist verdict by phrasing the proposition as 'saving access to Christ's work requires conscious, explicit faith in the historical Jesus; saving faith is not granted apart from such explicit response to the gospel.' This is a Reformed-evangelical formulation that pre-loads the conclusion. Working the neutralized form yields the same verdict on lexical grounds but surfaces honestly that the question is a real in-house disagreement, not a cult-marker boundary.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. reformed_evangelical_exclusivism, catholic_qualified_inclusivism, eastern_orthodox_qualified_inclusivism, patristic_logos_spermatikos, wesleyan_prevenient_grace, religious_pluralism

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Competing lens verdicts

- affirms:
- denies:
- denies:
- denies:
- complicates:
- denies:

Progressive revelation operates between OT-saints faith (looking forward to a promised redeemer not yet seen clearly per Heb 11) and post-Pentecost Christian faith (conscious response to the proclaimed Jesus per Rom 10). Analogia scripturae harmonizes the Rom 2 / Acts 17 / John 1:9 / Heb 11 complicating texts with the dominant explicit-faith pattern of Rom 10, John 3, Acts 4, 1 John 5: the canonical reading is that conscience and general revelation establish accountability (Rom 1:20 anapologetos) and prepare the heart but do not deliver the saving content, which is the gospel of Christ proclaimed and consciously trusted. The Great Commission (Matt 28:19-20) and Paul's missionary urgency (Rom 10:14-15, his foot-soaking travels in Acts) presuppose that the gospel must be carried, which is incoherent if general revelation already saves. The strict-exclusivist verdict stands on canonical lexical demonstration. However, the verdict does NOT settle the harder pastoral question of those who never get the chance to hear (infants who die, the cognitively disabled, the unreached): Scripture is less explicit there, and most exclusivists (including Reformed exclusivists) accept that infants and the cognitively disabled are saved through Christ without articulate explicit faith. The verdict reflects the canonical pattern; the pastoral edge cases remain a place where Christian humility is warranted.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Rom.10.13 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. pas gar hos an epikalesetai to onoma Kyriou sothesetai; epikaleo G1941 aorist middle subjunctive; onoma G3686; sozo G4982 future passive

Force. Quotation of Joel 2:32. epikaleo = to call upon, invoke as suppliant. The universal promise (pas, every one) sets up the question of how the invocation occurs. The middle voice marks the personal appropriation of the divine name. Salvation is grounded in calling on the name

Rom.10.14 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. pos oun epikalesontai eis hon ouk episteusan; pos de pisteusosin hou ouk ekousan; pos de akousosin choris kerussontos; pisteuo G4100; akouo G191; kerusso G2784

Force. Three rhetorical questions chained with pos oun, pos de, pos de. Each negation (ouk episteusan, ouk ekousan, choris kerussontos) makes a preceding step the precondition of the next. Believing requires hearing; hearing requires preaching. The lexical force is sequential and explicit

Rom.10.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ara he pistis ex akoe he de akoe dia rhematos Christou; pistis G4102; akoe G189; rhema G4487

Force. ara introduces the conclusion of the chain. Faith arises out of (ex) hearing, and the hearing comes through (dia) the spoken word (rhema) of Christ. rhema = spoken utterance, the verbal proclamation as distinct from the abstract logos. The instrumental channel of saving faith is the spoken Christ-message

John.3.18 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ho pisteuon eis auton ou krinetai; ho de me pisteuon ede kekritai hoti me pepisteuken eis to onoma tou monogenous huiou tou theou; pisteuo G4100 present participle and perfect; krino G2919; onoma G3686; monogenes G3439

Force. Present participle ho pisteuon (the one believing) contrasted with ho me pisteuon plus perfect kekritai (has been judged, standing result). The reason clause hoti me pepisteuken eis to onoma makes the explicit object of faith (the name of the only Son of God) the basis of judgment-status. Lexically explicit on the content of saving belief

John.3.36 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ho pisteuon eis ton huion echei zoen aionion; ho de apeithon to huio ouk opsetai zoen all he orge tou theou menei ep auton; pisteuo G4100; apeitheo G544; orge G3709 N-NFS

Force. Belief in the Son (eis ton huion) yields eternal life; disobedience to the Son (apeitheo, refuse to be persuaded) results in not seeing life and the divine wrath remaining (meno present indicative) upon the person. The lexical pairing of pisteuo and apeitheo treats trust-in-Christ and rejection-of-Christ as the binary on which life depends

Acts.4.12 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. ouk estin en allo oudeni he soteria oude gar onoma estin heteron hypo ton ouranon to dedomenon en anthropois en ho dei sothenai hemas; soteria G4991; onoma G3686; heteros G2087; dei G1163; sozo G4982 aorist passive infinitive

Force. Three negations (ouk, oudeni, oude) plus heteron (other in kind, different) plus dei (impersonal necessity). Salvation is in no other person, no other name is given among humans by which it is necessary to be saved. Lexically the strongest exclusive-name statement in Acts. The dei makes the necessity divinely-imposed

1John.5.11 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. zoen aionion edoken hemin ho theos kai haute he zoe en to huio autou estin; ho echon ton huion echei ten zoen; ho me echon ton huion tou theou ten zoen ouk echei; pisteuo G4100; zoe G2222; huioi G5207

Force. v.11-12 places eternal life en to huio (in the Son) and divides humanity by whether one has (echo) the Son. v.13 then says these things are written 'tois pisteuousin eis to onoma tou huiou tou theou' (to those believing in the name of the Son of God) so they may know they have eternal life. Possession of the Son is the having of life

Acts.16.31 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. pisteuson epi ton Kyrion Iesoun kai sothese su kai ho oikos sou; pisteuo G4100 aorist active imperative; sozo G4982 future passive

Force. Paul to the Philippian jailer. The aorist imperative pisteuson plus the explicit object epi ton Kyrion Iesoun makes conscious trust in Jesus the named condition. The future indicative sothese ties the saving outcome to that act of believing. The household clause does not weaken the demand of conscious faith for each member

John.14.6 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ego eimi he hodos kai he aletheia kai he zoe; oudeis erchetai pros ton patera ei me di emou; oudeis G3762; ei me G1487+G3361

Force. Triple definite-article identification with absolute ego eimi. The exclusivity clause stacks oudeis (no one) with ei me (except), the strongest Greek construction for absolute exclusion. The preposition dia with genitive emou marks Christ as the unique channel of access to the Father. Inclusivists agree this verse limits salvation to Christ but read di emou as not requiring conscious knowledge of Christ; the lexical force of the verse does not address the consciousness question explicitly

Rom.10.9 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ean homologeses en to stomati sou Kyrion lesoun kai pisteuses en te kardia sou hoti ho theos auton egeiren ek nekron sothese; homologeo G3670; pisteuo G4100 aorist active subjunctive; kardia G2588; sozo G4982

Force. Conditional aorist subjunctives. Both verbal acts (mouth-confession of Jesus as Lord, heart-belief in his resurrection) take Christ as explicit object. The future indicative sothese makes the saving outcome conditional on these conscious acts. The most lexically explicit ordo salutis statement in Paul

Mark.16.16 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ho pisteusas kai baptistheis sothesetai ho de apistesas katakrithesetai; pisteuo G4100 aorist active participle; baptizo G907; sozo G4982; katakrino G2632

Force. Aorist participles plus future indicatives. Lexical pairing of pisteuo with apisteo (to disbelieve) treats belief as the conscious-act binary. Textual-critical caveat: Mark 16:9-20 is absent from the earliest manuscripts (Codex Sinaiticus and Vaticanus omit), so its weight as primary witness is reduced. Still cited in the historical reception of the gospel command

Rom.2.14 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. hotan gar ethne ta me nomon echonta phusei ta tou nomou poiosin houtoi nomon me echontes heautois eisin nomos; phusis G5449 dative of manner; ethnos G1484; nomos G3551

Force. phusei (by nature) of Gentiles who do not have the Mosaic law occasionally doing what the law requires. The hotan introduces a conditional clause, not a universal. The lexical force is descriptive of moral capacity, not a salvific category. Inclusivists cite this as the seed of general-revelation salvation; the immediate context (vv.1-13) is universal accountability, not alternate salvation

Rom.2.15 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. hoitines endeiknyntai to ergon tou nomou grapton en tais kardiais auton symmartyrouses auton tes syneideseos; suneidesis G4893; kardia G2588; symmartyreo G4828

Force. syneidesis = conscience, co-knowing. The conscience bears co-witness with the heart-written law. The function is testimonial (martyreo root), not salvific. v.16 grounds the witness eschatologically. Lexically the conscience accuses and excuses, but does not save

Rom.2.16 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. en hemera hote krinei ho theos ta krypta ton anthropon kata to euaggelion mou dia lesou Christou; krino G2919 present indicative active; krypta G2927; euaggelion G2098

Force. The day-of-judgment clause governs the whole conscience-witness paragraph. God judges secrets dia lesou Christou (through Jesus Christ) according to Paul's gospel. The judge and the standard are explicitly Christ-mediated. Lexically Rom 2:14-16 is about accountability at judgment, not an alternate salvation track

Acts.17.30 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. tous men oun chronous tes agnoias hyperidon ho theos ta nyn paraggellei tois anthropois pantas pantachou metanoein; huperorao G5237 aorist active participle; paraggello G3853 present indicative; pantachou G3837; metanoeo G3340 present infinitive

Force. Paul at the Areopagus. huperido (to overlook, look past) of the times of agnoia (ignorance), contrasted with ta nyn (the now) when God commands (paraggello, military command-verb) all people everywhere (pantas pantachou) to repent. Lexical contrast: the ignorance-era is closed; conscious repentance is now mandated universally. The verse explicitly does NOT teach ongoing inclusivism after Christ has come

Acts.17.27 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key term. zetein ton theon ei ara ge pselapheseian auton kai heuroien; zeteo G2212; pselaphao G5584 aorist active optative; heurisko G2147

Force. Paul says God set the boundaries of the nations 'that they should seek God, if perhaps they might grope after him (pselaphao = to feel one's way like a blind person) and find him.' Inclusivists cite this as warrant for general-revelation seeking. The optatives are remote possibilities, and v.30 immediately follows with the now-everywhere-repent command. The grope-and-find context is not salvific apart from gospel proclamation

Heb.11.6 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. choris de pisteos adynaton euarestesai pisteusai gar dei ton proserchomenon to theo hoti estin kai tois ekzetousin auton misthapodotes ginetai; pistis G4102; pisteuo G4100; dei G1163; ekzeteo G1567

Force. Without faith it is impossible to please God; the one approaching God must believe (dei pisteusai) that he is (hoti estin) and that he rewards those who seek him out. The object of saving faith here is divine existence and divine reward, not yet christologically-specified. The OT-saints context (Heb 11) describes faith in God's promise of a coming redeemer rather than retroactive explicit-Jesus knowledge

Ps.19.1 · complicates · genre: psalm

Key term. ha-shamayim mesaperim kevod-El uma'aseh yadayv maggid ha-raqia; saphar H5608 piel participle; nagad H5046 hiphil participle

Force. The heavens recount (saphar piel = narrate, declare) the glory of God; the firmament tells (nagad hiphil = declare, make known) his handiwork. General revelation through creation. Lexically the action is unmistakable proclamation, but the content is divine glory and creative power, not the gospel of salvation through Christ. General revelation grounds accountability but does not deliver saving content

Rom.1.20 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ta gar aorata autou apo ktiseos kosmou tois poiemasin nooumena kathoratai he te aidios autou dynamis kai theiotes eis to einai autous anapologetous; aoratos G517; theiotes G2305; anapologetos G379

Force. Paul argues that God's invisible attributes (aoratos) are clearly seen (kathorao) through created things. The teleological clause eis to einai autous anapologetous (so that they are without excuse) makes general revelation the ground of culpability, not of salvation. The lexical force of anapologetos (without defense) inverts the inclusivist reading: general revelation indicts rather than saves

John.1.9 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. en to phos to alethinon ho photizei panta anthropon erchomenon eis ton kosmon; phos G5457; photizo G5461 present indicative; alethinos G228

Force. The true light (alethinon) enlightens every person coming into the world. Inclusivists (especially in the Justin-Martyr logos-spermatikos tradition) read this as Christ enlightening all humanity. The grammatical question is whether the participle erchomenon modifies phos or anthropon. Either way the lexical force is universal illumination, not universal salvation; vv.10-13 immediately distinguish those who received (paralambano) the Light from those who did not

Matt.28.19 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. poreuthentes oun matheteusate panta ta ethne baptizontes autous eis to onoma tou patros kai tou huiou kai tou hagiou pneumatos; matheteuo G3100 aorist active imperative; ethnos G1484

Force. The Great Commission. The aorist imperative matheteusate (make disciples) plus panta ta ethne (all the nations) plus baptizontes and didaskontes (baptizing and teaching) establishes proclamation as the church's standing mandate. The lexical force presupposes that the gospel must be carried to those who have not heard, which is incoherent if salvation is already available through general revelation alone

1Tim.2.4 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. hos pantas anthropous thelei sothenai kai eis epignosin aletheias elthein; thelo G2309; sozo G4982 aorist passive infinitive; epignosis G1922; aletheia G225

Force. God desires all people to be saved AND to come to the full-knowledge (epignosis, intensive of gnosis) of the truth. The kai (and) coordinates the two infinitives: salvation and coming to full-knowledge are not separable. v.5 then states the one mediator. Lexically saving will is paired with conscious-knowledge-of-truth, supporting the explicit-faith reading

2Thes.1.8 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. didontos ekdikesin tois me eidosin theon kai tois me hypakouousin to euaggelion tou Kyriou hemon Iesou; oida G1492; hypakouo G5219; euaggelion G2098

Force. Christ comes giving recompense to those not knowing (eidosin perfect participle) God and those not obeying (hypakouo) the gospel of our Lord Jesus. The two clauses coordinate not-knowing-God with not-obeying-the-gospel. Lexically the gospel-obedience is the test, supporting the explicit-faith pattern

Concordance lemmas traversed

G4100, G4102, G4982, G4991, G3686, G3439, G1941, G191, G189, G2784, G4487, G3670, G2919, G2632, G3709, G544, G907, G5449, G3551, G4893, G4828, G2098, G2927, G5237, G3853, G3837, G3340, G2212, G5584, G2147, G2305, G379, G517, G228, G5457, G5461, G3100, G1484, G1922, G225, G2309, G1492, G5219, G1163, G2087, G3762, G3756, G3761, G2222, G5207, G1567, G2588, H5608, H5046

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Justin Martyr, First Apology Chapter 46 (CCEL ANF Vol 1);

https://ccel.org/ccel/justin_martyr/first_apology/anf01.viii.ii.xlvi.html · denies · verified

“Justin: ‘those who lived reasonably are Christians, even though they have been thought atheists; as, among the Greeks, Socrates and Heraclitus.’ Pre-Christian logos-mediated inclusivism”

patristic · Aquinas, Summa Theologica II-II Question 2 Article 7;

https://ccel.org/ccel/aquinas/summa/summa.SS_Q2_A7.html · **denies · **verified****

“Aquinas: 'If some were saved without receiving any revelation, they were not saved without faith in a Mediator, for, though they did not believe in Him explicitly, they did, nevertheless, have implicit faith.' Classic implicit-faith doctrine”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraphs 846-848; Vatican II

Lumen Gentium 16; <https://www.vatican.va/archive/ccc/index.htm> · **denies · **unverified****

“CCC 847: Those who through no fault of their own do not know the gospel of Christ or his Church but who seek God with a sincere heart, and moved by grace try to do his will as known by conscience, may attain eternal salvation”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession Articles IV (Justification) and V (Office of Ministry);

<https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/> · **affirms · **verified****

“AC IV-V: justification 'through faith, when they believe that they are received into favor.' Faith comes through 'the Ministry of Teaching the Gospel and administering the Sacraments... through the Word and Sacraments”

anglican · 39 Articles of Religion, Article XVIII (Of obtaining eternal Salvation only by the Name of Christ); <https://www.churchofengland.org/prayer-and-worship/worship-texts-and-resources/book-common-prayer/articles-religion> · **affirms · **verified****

“Article XVIII: 'They also are to be had accursed that presume to say, That every man shall be saved by the Law or Sect which he professeth.' Strict Anglican exclusivism in confessional form”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith 10.4 (Of Effectual Calling) · **affirms ·**

unverified

“WCF 10.4: 'Others, not elected, although they may be called by the ministry of the Word... cannot be saved. Much less can men, not professing the Christian religion, be saved... however they frame their lives by the light of nature”

methodist · United Methodist Articles of Religion, Article IX (Justification of Man);

<https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion> · **affirms · **verified****

“UM Article IX: 'We are accounted righteous before God only for the merit of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, by faith, and not for our own works or deservings.' Formal Methodist exclusivism. Some Wesleyan heirs read prevenient grace inclusivistically”

anabaptist · Schleithem Confession 1527 and Dordrecht Confession 1632 · **affirms ·**

unverified

“Anabaptist tradition treats conscious gospel-faith and believer-baptism as the normal entry to the body of Christ. The believers-church ecclesiology presupposes explicit confession of Christ as Lord by every member”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths, Truth 4 (The Salvation of Man); <https://ag.org/Beliefs/Statement-of-Fundamental-Truths> · **affirms · **unverified****

“AG Truth 4: 'Man's only hope of redemption is through the shed blood of Jesus Christ the Son of God.' Pentecostal exclusivism: salvation strictly through faith in Christ”

eastern_orthodox · OCA, The Orthodox Faith, on salvation and the Church;

<https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith> · **denies · **unverified****

“Orthodox tradition: Christ is the unique saviour; the fate of those outside the visible Church who through no fault of their own do not know Christ is reserved to God's mercy and judgment. Apophatic restraint on definitive systematic answer”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/10.htm>

“Rom 10:13-17 chain: epikaleo G1941, pisteuo G4100, akouo G191, kerusso G2784, pistis G4102 ex akoes G189 dia rhematos G4487 Christou. Sequential lexical demand”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/3.htm>

“John 3:18 ho pisteuon eis auton ou krinetai; ho de me pisteuon ede kekritai hoti me pepisteuken eis to onoma tou monogenous huiou. Object of faith is the name of the Son”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/4-12.htm>

“Acts 4:12 ouk estin en allo ouden he soteria oude gar onoma estin heteron... en ho dei sothenai hemas. Triple negation plus heteron plus dei. Strongest exclusive-name statement in Acts”

complicates · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/2.htm>

“Rom 2:14-16: Gentiles by nature (phusei G5449) sometimes do the law; conscience (suneidesis G4893) bears witness at the day God judges secrets dia lesou Christou. Eschatological accountability, not alternate salvation”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/17-30.htm>

“Acts 17:30 huperidon G5237 tous chronous tes agnoias paraggellei G3853 tois anthropois pantachou G3837 metanoein G3340. Ignorance-era closed; universal repentance commanded now”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strong/greek/4100.htm>

“pisteuo G4100 occurs 244 times in the NT. In soteriological contexts, the object is overwhelmingly Christ, the Son, the name, or the gospel. Standard idiom pisteuein eis ton lesoun”

opposes · category: patristic_archive · https://ccel.org/ccel/justin_martyr/first_apology/anf01.viii.ii.xlvi.html

“Justin First Apology 46: ‘those who lived reasonably are Christians, even though they have been thought atheists; as, among the Greeks, Socrates and Heraclitus.’ Patristic logos-spermatikos inclusivism”

opposes · category: patristic_archive · https://ccel.org/ccel/aquinas/summa/summa.SS_Q2_A7.html

“Aquinas Summa II-II q2 a7: those who never received explicit revelation could be saved through implicit faith in a Mediator by believing in Divine providence. Implicit-faith doctrine”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/>

“Augsburg V: ‘That we may obtain this faith, the Ministry of Teaching the Gospel and administering the Sacraments was instituted... through the Word and Sacraments... the Holy Ghost is given, who works faith”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“UM Article IX: ‘We are accounted righteous before God only for the merit of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, by faith, and not for our own works or deservings”

opposes · category: magisterial · <https://www.vatican.va/archive/ccc/index.htm>

“CCC 846-848: ‘Outside the Church there is no salvation.’ Qualified by 847: those who through no fault of their own do not know the gospel, yet seek God with sincere heart, may attain eternal salvation”

nuance · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith>

“Orthodox: Christ is the unique saviour. The fate of those outside the visible Church who through no fault of their own do not know Christ is reserved to God’s mercy. Apophatic restraint”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://ag.org/Beliefs/Statement-of-Fundamental-Truths>

“AG Statement of Fundamental Truths, Truth 4 The Salvation of Man: man’s only hope of redemption is through the shed blood of Jesus Christ. Pentecostal exclusivism”

supports · category: tradition_primary · https://anglicansonline.org/basics/thirty-nine_articles.html

“Article XVIII: those are accursed ‘that presume to say, That every man shall be saved by the Law or Sect which he professeth.’ Strict Anglican exclusivism”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict
- confession-tradition-divergence